Ford Motor Company

A.R. O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs
48121
Ford Customer Service Division

Ford Motor Company
P. O. Box 1904
Dearborn, Michigan

October 2001

TO: All Ford and Lincoln Mercury Dealers

SUBJECT: Safety Recall 01S29: Certain 2001 Model Year U.S. Postal Stripped Chassis Vehicles--Front Suspension Mounting Bracket Bolt Inspection

AFFECTED VEHICLES

Certain 2001 model year U.S. Postal Stripped Chassis vehicles built at the Detroit Chassis Plant from July 18, 2000 through February 15, 2001.

SAFETY CONCERN

In some of the affected vehicles the fasteners for suspension mounting brackets located on the left and right frame rail may not have been properly installed resulting in either loose or missing fasteners. The presence of loose or missing fasteners may result in noise from the front of the vehicle during normal driving. Low speed maneuverability may be moderately affected, primarily due to an increase in body roll. Engineering evaluations at higher speeds indicate a degradation in limit handling capability which would not satisfy Ford's criteria.

SERVICE ACTION

The dealer must inspect for loose or missing front suspension mounting bracket retaining bolts on both, the left and right hand, brackets and replace or tighten the bolts for each bracket to the recommended specification. This must be done on all affected vehicles.

PLEASE NOTE

Correct all vehicles in stock before delivery. Federal law requires dealers to complete any outstanding safety recall service before a new vehicle is delivered to the buyer or lessee. Violation of this requirement by a dealer could result in a civil penalty of up to $5,000 per vehicle.

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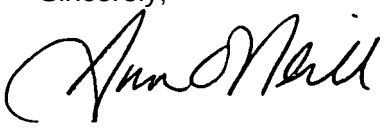
ATTACHMENTS

Attachment I: Administrative Information
Attachment II: Labor Allowances and Parts Ordering Information
Attachment III: Technical Information
Customer Notification Letter(s)

QUESTIONS?

Claims Information:……..……...1-800-423-8851
Other (Dealer Only) Recall Questions:……..……...1-800-325-5621

Sincerely,



Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs

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Safety Recall 01S29
Certain 2001 Model Year U.S. Postal Stripped Chassis Vehicles
Suspension Mounting Bracket Bolt Inspection

OASIS

You must use OASIS to determine if a vehicle is eligible for this recall.

PROMPTLY CORRECT

Promptly correct all affected vehicles on your dealer Online Involved Unit Listing available on QCDealer.com. Also, correct other affected vehicles identified in OASIS which are brought to your dealership.

DEALER-OWNER CONTACT

Immediately contact any of your affected owners whose names are not on your VIN list but identified in OASIS. Give the owner a copy of the Owner Letter and schedule a service date.

REGIONAL CONTACT

Advise regional office if an owner:

- cannot be contacted.
- does not make a service date.

CLAIMS PREPARATION AND SUBMISSION

- Enter claims using DWE.
- Refer to ACESII manual for claims preparation and submission information.

OWNER REFUNDS

Ford Motor Company will only refund owner-paid repairs applicable to this recall which were made before the date of the Owner Letter (or after the date of the Owner Letter if an emergency repair was made away from the servicing dealer). Refer to ACESII manual for refund information.

RENTAL CARS

Rental vehicles are not approved for this program.

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LABOR ALLOWANCES

Description	Labor Operation	Labor Time
Torque both left and right hand front stabilizer bar mounting bracket bolts to 40Nm(30Lb/Ft)	01S29B	0.2 Hour
Inspect loose bolts for damage and replace one or more front stabilizer bar mounting bracket bolts.	01S29C	0.3 Hour
Administrative Allowance	Misc. Expense Code "ADMIN"	0.1 Hour

PARTS REQUIREMENTS

Parts Ordering Information

Parts will not be direct shipped for this recall. Order your parts requirement through normal order processing channels as noted below:

Stock Orders	Effective immediately	Normal order process
Interim Orders	Effective immediately	Normal order process
Emergency Orders	First 30 days after launch	Call 1-800-325-5621
Emergency Orders	31 days after launch	Normal order process

Part Number	Description	Quantity
N811848-S100	Stabilizer Bar Bracket Bolts (Package of 4)	As Required

ORDER INFORMATION

DOR/COR number is 50263. This number identifies parts ordered for this field service action through the Special Service Support Center (1-800-325-5621).

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PARTS RETENTION

Follow the provisions of the Warranty and Policy Manual for “Parts Retention and Return Procedures”.

DEALER PRICE

For latest prices, refer to DOES II or updated price book.

EXCESS STOCK RETURN

Excess stock returned for credit must have been purchased from Ford Customer Service Division in accordance with Policy Procedure Bulletin 4000.

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A.R. O'Neill
Ford Motor Company
P. O. Box 1904
Dearborn, Michigan 48121
www.ownerconnection.com

October 2001

01S29

United States Postal Service
123 Main Street
Anywhere, USA 12345

This notice is sent to you in accordance with the requirements of the National Traffic and Motor Vehicle Safety Act.

Ford Motor Company has decided that an assembly issue which relates to motor vehicle safety exists in certain 2001 model year United States Postal Service vehicles built on a Ford stripped chassis.

We apologize for this situation and want to assure you that with your assistance, we will correct this condition. Our commitment is to provide you with the highest level of service and support possible.

What the issue is …

In some of the affected vehicles, it is possible that the front suspension mounting bracket bolts may be loose or missing. Loose or missing mounting bracket bolts could result in a reduction in high-speed vehicle handling capabilities.

What Ford Motor Company and your dealer will do ...

Ford Motor Company will repair your vehicle free of charge (parts and labor). The dealer will replace any missing or damaged mounting bracket bolts and tighten all bolts to specification.

How long will it take?

The time needed for this repair is less than one-half day. However, due to service scheduling requirements, your dealer may need your vehicle for a longer period of time.

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What we are asking you to do …

Call your dealer without delay. If you do not already have a servicing dealer, please access www.dealerconnection.com for dealer addresses, maps, and driving instructions. Ask for a service date for Safety Recall 01S29.

When you bring your vehicle in, show the dealer this letter. However, If you misplace this letter, your dealer will still do the work, free of charge.

If you've already paid for this service …

If you paid to have this service done before the date of this letter, Ford is offering a refund. To receive the refund, please give your paid original receipt to your dealer. To avoid delays, do not send receipts to Ford Motor Company.

If you've changed address or sold the vehicle …

Please fill out the enclosed prepaid postcard and mail it to us so we can update our records. If you have sold the vehicle, the information you provide on the postcard will be used to notify the new owner about this recall.

If you have concerns …

If you have trouble getting your vehicle repaired promptly and without charge, please contact your dealership's Service Manager for assistance. If you still have concerns, please contact the Ford Motor Company Customer Relationship Center and one of our representatives will be happy to assist you:

Call (866) 436-7332

Office Hours (Eastern Time Zone)
Monday – Friday: 8AM – 11PM
Saturday: 8AM – 6PM

Hearing impaired call (800) 232-2952
TDD for the hearing impaired.

Or you may contact us through the Internet …

www.ownerconnection.com

If you are still having trouble getting your vehicle repaired and without charge, you may write the Administrator, National Highway Traffic Safety Administration, 400 Seventh Street S. W., Washington, D. C. 20590 or call the toll free Auto Safety Hotline at 1-888-327-4236 or 1-800-424-9393.

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Quality Care service is there for you all year long.

Quality Care is the commitment of Ford Motor Company and its dealerships to provide you with a superior service and ownership experience. While we regret the inconvenience caused by this program, we stand committed with our dealers to assist you with all of your automotive service needs. With our nationwide dealer network, we're here to ensure you receive Quality Care service so that your vehicle maintains peak performance throughout your ownership experience.

We pride ourselves on becoming the world's leading consumer company providing automotive products and services. Thank you for your attention to this important matter.

Sincerely,



Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs

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